availability of tanks was limited so one squadron of each regiment was equipped with Humber armoured cars.

To replace the .303 SMLE bolt-action rifles then in use with the Army, it was decided to produce a copy of the British 7.62mm L1A1 SLR (itself a copy of the Belgian 7.62mm FN FAL battle rifle) in India. Production started in 1960, though the rifle was initially not produced in sufficient numbers to equip all units when India went to war against China in 1962.

During 1959–60, three infantry divisions were formed, two (20 and 23) in the east in and one (17) at Ambala in the (then) Punjab. Of these, 20 was located in the Ranchi–Ramgarh area while 23 was tasked with counter-insurgency operations against Naga insurgents. Neither would be available immediately when Chinese forces attacked on 20 October 1962. Two more infantry divisions (2 and 3) were to be formed but only after the Chinese attack.

Paucity of formations in the east was not the problem in October 1962 as HQ Eastern Command was located in faraway Lucknow at that time. It had moved from Ranchi in February 1955 and was made responsible for counter-insurgency operations against Naga insurgents in 1956. It had no divisional or corps headquarters until September 1959, when 23 Infantry Division was formed. Later that year 4 Infantry Division was moved from the Punjab and placed under Eastern Command. As Eastern Command lacked a corps headquarters, HQ XXXIII Corps was raised at Shillong on 1 November 1960, led by Lieutenant General Umrao Singh. Initially it had only 4 Infantry Division under command, joined in October 1962 by 20 Infantry Division. A second corps headquarters, IV Corps, was raised just before hostilities broke out with China, with Lieutenant General Brij Mohan Kaul as its first GOC. It was made responsible for the North East Frontier area.